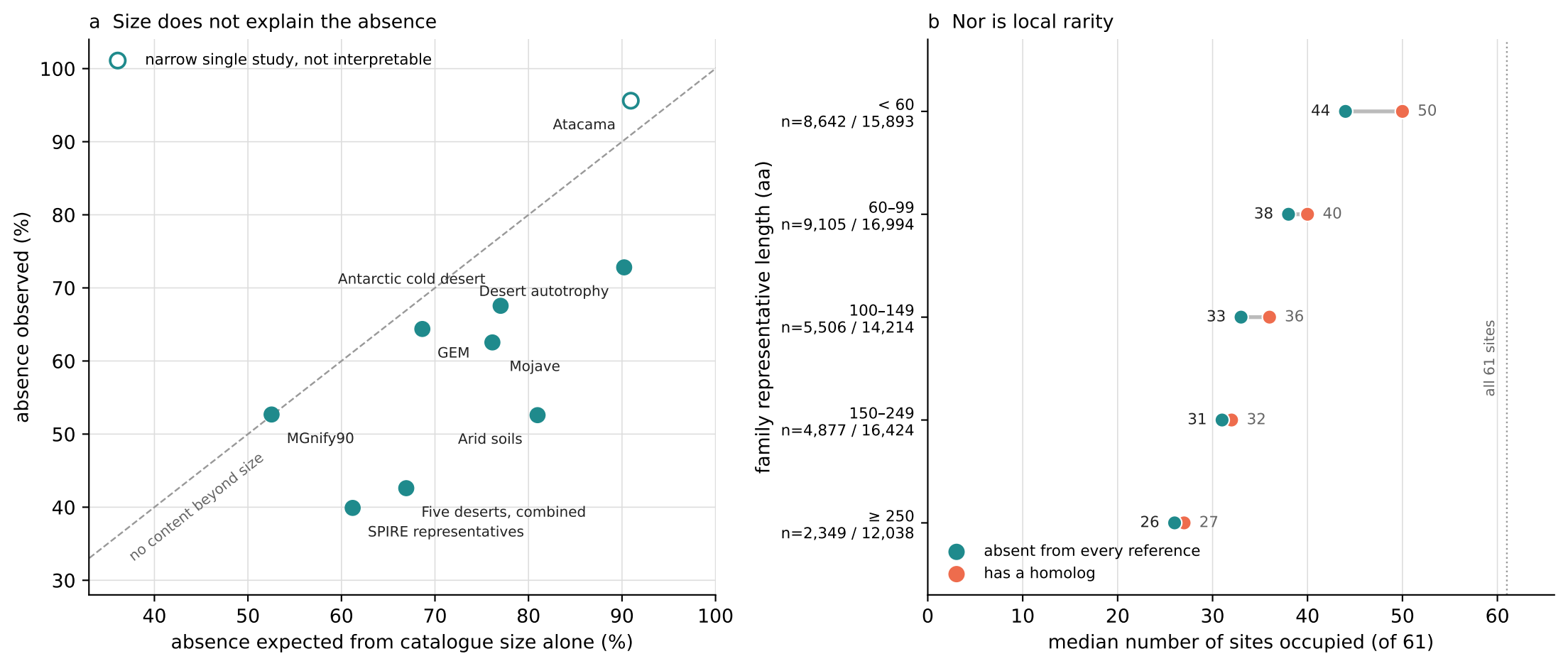
a Size does not explain the absence
narrow single study, not interpretable
Atacama
Antarctic cold desert
Desert autotrophy
GEM
Mojave
MGnify90
Arid soils
Five deserts, combined
SPIRE representatives
no content beyond size
absence observed (%)
absence expected from catalogue size alone (%)
b Nor is local rarity
family representative length (aa)
< 60
n=8,642 / 15,893
60–99
n=9,105 / 16,994
100–149
n=5,506 / 14,214
150–249
n=4,877 / 16,424
≥ 250
n=2,349 / 12,038
44
50
38
40
33
36
31
32
26
27
all 61 sites
absent from every reference
has a homolog
median number of sites occupied (of 61)